INTERNAL · NOT FOR SENDING

Outreach Kit

Templates for four audiences, a follow-up sequence, the tracker structure, and the scraper spec. Target: KSh 100,000 in three weeks from two or three fixed-price jobs at 50% upfront.

> THE FOUR RULES THAT DECIDE WHETHER THIS WORKS
>
> **1.** One specific observation about them in the first line. No observation, no send — that line is the difference between a reply and a delete.
>
> **2.** Ask for a 15-minute call, never for work. “Are you the right person to talk to about X?” outperforms every pitch.
>
> **3.** 15–20 hand-edited messages a day from your own Gmail. Never a bulk send — a fresh sending domain goes straight to spam and burns the address.
>
> **4.** Ask every reply, including every no, for one referral. Half your eventual work comes from there.

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1 · Agencies and dev shops

The highest-volume source. You are not asking for a job — you are offering overflow capacity, which is a problem they genuinely have. Keep it short; these people are busy and read fast.

EMAIL · SUBJECT: BACKEND OVERFLOW WORK — GO / M-PESA

Hi [Name],

I came across [Agency] — [OBSERVATION: the specific thing, e.g. "you built the ordering app for X" / "your portfolio is mostly Flutter and web front-end"].

I'm a backend engineer in Nairobi: Go, Postgres, M-Pesa integrations, APIs for mobile teams. I work as a subcontractor for agencies on fixed-price scopes — you keep the client relationship, I deliver the server side, 5 days to 2 weeks per job.

If a project ever needs payments done properly or an API your Flutter team can build against, I'd like to be the person you call. Worth a 15-minute call this week?

Anthony
+254 700 536 326 · antho-tech.netlify.app
[attach: offer sheet]

LINKEDIN DM · UNDER 300 CHARACTERS, NO LINK IN THE FIRST MESSAGE

Hi [Name] — saw [OBSERVATION]. I'm a Go/Postgres backend dev in Nairobi doing subcontract work for agencies: M-Pesa integrations and APIs for mobile teams, fixed price per scope. Do you ever outsource backend work? Happy to send a one-pager.

WHATSAPP · ONLY WHERE THE NUMBER IS PUBLICLY LISTED AS A BUSINESS LINE

Hello [Name], Anthony here — backend developer (Go, Postgres, M-Pesa). I saw [OBSERVATION]. I take on backend and payments work for agencies on fixed-price scopes. Sending my one-pager in case it's useful — is backend something you currently outsource?

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2 · Incubator startups — your best list

Chandaria, Nairobi Garage, iHub and similar. Almost all of them need payments and a backend, few have a backend engineer, and you are a peer rather than a vendor — lead with that. Ask a programme manager for introductions before you cold-message founders; one warm intro beats fifty emails.

TO A PROGRAMME / INNOVATION MANAGER

Hi [Name],

I'm Anthony, a backend engineer working on [your platform] — [OBSERVATION: your own connection to the centre, cohort, event you attended].

Most early teams I meet hit the same wall: M-Pesa payments and a backend for their app, with no server-side engineer on the team. That's exactly what I do, on short fixed-price scopes that fit a startup budget.

Would you be open to pointing me at two or three teams in the current cohort who are stuck there? Happy to do a free 30-minute review for any of them so they can judge the value first.

Anthony
+254 700 536 326

TO A FOUNDER DIRECTLY

Hi [Name],

[OBSERVATION: I tried your app and payment is manual / your site has no checkout / you mentioned you're pre-launch on X].

I'm a backend engineer — Go, Postgres, M-Pesa. I've just finished designing the payments and wallet architecture for a mobility platform, so this is fresh: STK push, verified callbacks, no double charges, automatic reconciliation.

If getting payments working is on your critical path, I can do it in 5 days for a fixed KSh 55,000, half upfront. Want a 15-minute call to see if it fits?

Anthony · +254 700 536 326

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3 · Companies hiring backend developers

Anyone advertising for a Go, Python or Node backend developer has budget approved and a project waiting. Hiring takes them two months; you can start Monday. This is the highest-conversion cold list because the pain is live and funded — and it is not competitive with your remote job search, it feeds it.

EMAIL · SUBJECT: YOUR BACKEND ROLE — CONTRACT COVER WHILE YOU HIRE

Hi [Name],

I saw you're hiring a [role] — [OBSERVATION: the specific stack or product mentioned in the ad].

Filling that seat usually takes a couple of months. If something is blocked in the meantime, I can work on contract from this week: Go, Postgres, Redis, M-Pesa integrations, APIs for mobile teams. Fixed price per scope, no notice period, and it doesn't interfere with your hiring.

Two questions and I'll know if I can help: what's the most urgent thing waiting on that hire, and when did you need it live?

Anthony · +254 700 536 326 · github.com/anthonyalando8

4 · SMEs with a visible payments or systems mess

Schools, clinics, gyms, SACCOs, delivery, hardware and wholesale businesses. Never use technical words with them — no “API”, no “integration”, no “backend”. Talk about the manual work they do every evening. Phone calls convert far better than email here; the message is just the door-opener.

WHATSAPP / EMAIL

Hello [Name],

I noticed [OBSERVATION: customers pay you on the till and someone confirms each payment by hand / your website has no way to pay online / bookings come in by WhatsApp].

I build small systems that remove that daily work: payments confirmed automatically and matched to the right customer, receipts sent on their own, and one simple report at the end of the day. It takes about a week and costs a fixed amount agreed before we start.

Would a quick call tomorrow be useful? I'll tell you honestly whether it's worth doing for a business your size.

Anthony Alando · +254 700 536 326

PHONE OPENER · 20 SECONDS, THEN STOP TALKING

“Good morning, is this [Name]? My name is Anthony, I build business systems here in Nairobi — I'm not selling anything on this call. I noticed [OBSERVATION]. Can I ask, who currently checks that payments have come in, and how long does that take each day?”

→ then listen. The number they say is your quote. If the answer is "two hours a day", the job is worth KSh 55,000 to them and you say so.

5 · Follow-ups, and the referral ask

Most replies come from follow-up two, not the first message. Two follow-ups, then stop — a third annoys people and costs you the future referral.

When	Message
Day 3	“Hi [Name] — following up on the note below in case it got buried. One line is enough: is backend/payments work something you'd ever outsource? If not, no problem and I won't chase.”
Day 8	Give something instead of asking: “Last note from me. I wrote up how to make M-Pesa payments reliable — the reconciliation part most integrations skip. Sending it in case it's useful to whoever handles that for you. Good luck with [their thing].”
Any reply, including a no	“Understood, thanks for replying. One favour — is there anyone you know who's stuck on payments or a backend right now? A name is all I need.”

On the call, three questions do the work: *what breaks today*, *what does it cost you when it breaks*, *when do you need it live*. Then quote a fixed price from the sheet, on the call, out loud. Never “let me send a proposal” — that's how a warm call goes cold. Send the written scope the same evening while they still remember.

5b · Money terms, and the “come work for us” reply

You have a salaried job, so you are not selling availability — you are selling a solved problem in your own hours. That is leverage: no desperation discount, and you may decline anything paid in arrears. **The goal in three weeks is three signed scopes with deposits paid, not three finished projects.** Three deposits at KSh 55,000 is KSh 82,500 in hand before any balance lands.

They say	You say
“Come work for us, we pay end month.”	“I'm not available for employment — I'm in a role already. I take project work at a fixed price, half upfront and half on handover. Shall I scope the payments piece on that basis?” Then quote. Many still buy the project.
“Can we do net-30 / pay after delivery?”	“I work half upfront — it's how I hold the delivery date for you. If cash flow is the issue, I can split it into two smaller scopes of KSh 30,000 each so you pay as each piece lands.” Smaller scope, never later payment.
“Can you do it hourly?”	“Fixed price protects you more than hourly does — you know the number before we start, and overruns are my problem, not yours.”
“Too expensive.”	“Understood. What's the smallest version that would still be worth it to you?” Cut scope to fit their number, never cut the price for the same scope.
“Do a small test task free first.”	“I'll do a free 30-minute review and tell you exactly what's wrong — that's the sample. Build work starts on deposit.”

Say your capacity honestly and it becomes a selling point: *“I work evenings and weekends on client projects, which is why I quote seven days rather than three — the date I give you is one I'll actually hit.”* Deadlines you keep are how a first client becomes a retainer.

Deposit mechanics: M-Pesa or bank, your details on the scope document, deposit requested in the same message as the scope. Work starts when it reflects — say that warmly and once, then hold it. A client who won't pay 50% upfront on a KSh 55,000 job is the client who won't pay the balance either.

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6 · Tracker

One sheet, these columns, 100 rows. Fill the list in one sitting, then work it daily — the sheet is what stops you from re-researching the same company three times.

```
company | segment | name | role | channel | contact | OBSERVATION | sent_at |
followup_1 | followup_2 | reply | call_booked | quoted_amount | status | notes

segment  agency · incubator · hiring · sme
status   new → sent → replied → call → quoted → WON / lost / referred
target   100 rows: 25 incubator · 25 hiring · 30 agency · 20 sme
daily    15 sends + 10 follow-ups.  Weekly review: which segment replies? Double it.
Expect roughly: 100 sends → 12-20 replies → 5-8 calls → 2-3 jobs. That is enough.
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7 · Scraper spec — build in one evening

Hand this to Claude Code. Go or Python, single binary or script, no framework. It automates the *research*, never the sending or the judgment. Time-box it: if it isn't producing rows in three hours, ship a smaller version and start messaging.

```
GOAL   produce prospects.csv with one row per company, ready for the tracker,
       each row carrying enough detail to write a real first line.

STAGE 1  seed lists
  clutch.co / goodfirms.co  — filter Kenya, web + mobile development
  google search scrape      — "web development agency Nairobi", "software company
                              Kenya", site:linkedin.com/company nairobi software
  job boards                — brightermonday.co.ke, fuzu.com, myjobmag.co.ke,
                              LinkedIn jobs: golang|backend|django|node + Kenya
  play store                — Kenyan apps in Finance/Shopping/Transport, read the
                              developer website + the 1-2 star reviews (payment
                              failures are your opening line, verbatim)
  DO NOT scrape LinkedIn profiles or send LinkedIn DMs from a script. Both get the
  account restricted. Search there manually, message by hand.

STAGE 2  enrich each company (polite crawler)
  fetch homepage + /about + /contact + /careers   (follow ≤10 internal links)
  extract  emails (regex, prefer named over info@) · phone/WhatsApp numbers ·
           social links · tech signals (Shopify/WooCommerce/Flutter/Firebase in the
           HTML) · presence of a checkout or "pay online" · paybill/till numbers ·
           open job ads mentioning backend
  respect  robots.txt · 1 request/sec per host · real User-Agent with your email ·
           cache every page to disk so a re-run costs nothing

STAGE 3  score and segment
  segment  = agency | incubator | hiring | sme   (rules over the signals above)
  score    + hiring backend now (+3) · payment complaints in reviews (+3) ·
             no checkout but sells (+2) · named contact found (+2) ·
             agency with no backend in portfolio (+2) · dead site / no updates (−2)
  sort desc, take the top 100. Ignore the rest — the list is not the constraint.

STAGE 4  draft generation (Claude API)
  for each row: prompt with {company, segment, signals, evidence snippets} + the
  matching template from §1-4, and require the model to write ONLY the first-line
  observation plus a one-line hypothesis of their problem. Everything else stays
  template text.  If the model cannot cite a concrete signal, mark the row
  needs_manual and move on — a fabricated observation destroys the message.
  output  drafts.csv (company, channel, to, subject, body, evidence_used)

STAGE 5  you review
  open drafts.csv, edit tone in your own words, send from Gmail / WhatsApp / phone
  by hand, 15-20 a day. Paste the send time back into the tracker.
  NO automated sending. Fresh-domain bulk email lands in spam and burns the address.

EFFORT  stage 1-2: 2-3 h · stage 3: 30 min · stage 4: 1 h · total one evening.
        Worth it at 100+ prospects. Below 40, just do it by hand tonight.
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8 · The three weeks

When	Do this
Tonight	Export the offer sheet to PDF. Build the first 30 rows by hand — incubator contacts and this week's backend job ads. Send 10 messages before you sleep. Do not build the scraper first.
Day 2–3	Scraper evening; grow the list to 100. Keep sending 15/day regardless. Ask two people from your Kabu team and your incubator contact for introductions — those land fastest.
Week 1 end	Expect 3–6 calls. Quote on the call, send the scope the same evening, ask for 50% upfront to start Monday. **First cash should land in week one** — that's the whole point of upfront.
Week 2	Deliver job one. Keep sending — the biggest mistake is stopping outreach the day you get work, which guarantees a dry week three. One hour of sending every morning before you code.
Week 3	Deliver, invoice balances, collect. Convert one client to a small monthly support retainer so month two doesn't start from zero. Then — and only then — build the job-application tool for the remote search.

> THE FAILURE MODE TO WATCH FOR IN YOURSELF
>
> Building feels productive and selling feels awful, so under pressure you will drift toward the scraper, the job bot, the portfolio redesign — anything with a keyboard. None of those bring KSh 100,000 in three weeks. Fifteen messages a day does. If a day ends with commits but no sends, the day was a loss.